

MODERN BRANDS

The influence of marketing and advertising from the mid-19th century onwards transformed the way consumers perceived jewellery. It was no longer simply an asset with a value based on gem quality, metal content, and rarity: the value now came from its brand association, too. Jewellery was presented to the consumer as a symbol of a particular lifestyle that extended beyond rings and watches to encompass fragrance and homewares, culture and the arts, exclusive sporting events, and celebrities on the red carpet.

Tiffany & Co. took the lead in the USA in 1845, publishing its Blue Book jewellery catalogue, which was one of the first of its kind. Refining the colour theme, in 1878 it introduced its signature blue colour to packaging and advertising, which became integral to the brand's image. Cartier, meanwhile, used its links with European royalty to create an identity of prestige and refined taste. It launched a line of lifestyle products, Les Must de Cartier, and sponsored events such as polo to cement its image of exclusivity. Other brands, from upscale Van Cleef & Arpels to mass-market Pandora, have since projected their identities to the public in a similar way.

I've never thought of my jewellery as trophies... we are only temporary custodians of beauty

Elizabeth **Taylor**

Actress

Panthère de Cartier watch Playful and powerful, and representing elegance, power, and luxury, the big cat has been incorporated in many of Cartier's luxury watches, such as this lavish example, and other decorative jewellery pieces in its Panther collection.

